

Items 1-5

Instructions: Choose the word or phrase that is nearest to **OPPOSITE** in meaning to the underlined word or phrase.

1. The tourist brochure gave verbose accounts of the carnival festivities of last year.
 - (A) concise
 - (B) pleasing
 - (C) accurate
 - (D) colourful
2. We found her appreciative of the help that we had given to her on this matter.
 - (A) intolerant of
 - (B) displeased at
 - (C) ungrateful for
 - (D) unhappy about
3. As a result of the need for trained staff, the firm had to dismiss several workers.
 - (A) deport
 - (B) employ
 - (C) promote
 - (D) transport
4. The headgear worn by the factory worker is made from artificial material.
 - (A) natural
 - (B) synthetic
 - (C) man-made
 - (D) prefabricated
5. The old lady enjoyed making malicious remarks to everyone she met.
 - (A) kind
 - (B) polite
 - (C) truthful
 - (D) amusing

Instructions: Each sentence has either one or two words missing. Choose from the four options the word or pair of words which BEST completes the meaning of the sentence. Mark your choice on the answer sheet.

6. people are likely to be afraid to take risks in life.
- (A) Wealthy
 - (B) Selfish
 - (C) Cautious
 - (D) Knowledgeable
7. When parents display a for one child, the others are likely to feel
- (A) concern ... unsympathetic
 - (B) dislike ... indifferent
 - (C) preference ... jealous
 - (D) fondness ... lonely
8. An attack on someone when that person is most vulnerable may be but is always
- (A) inappropriate thoughtful
 - (B) rewarding satisfying
 - (C) destructive distressing
 - (D) effective unkind
9. While the Committee members insults across the floor, the Chairman tried in vain to order.
- (A) hurled restore
 - (B) spoke impose
 - (C) gave maintain
 - (D) exchanged conserve
10. Are you trying to that all along he knew of the plot to oust the committee?
- (A) clarify
 - (B) accuse
 - (C) persist
 - (D) insinuate

Items 11-15

Instructions: Each sentence in this section is followed by four sentences A, B, C and D. Choose the one NEAREST IN MEANING to the original sentence.

11. Recent floods have made the route impassable.
- (A) People are unable to travel because of the floods.
 - (B) The road cannot be used as a result of the floods.
 - (C) Because of heavy showers, commuters were forced to detour.
 - (D) Travelling has been brought to a standstill because of floods.
12. An interest in their nation's development plans should be displayed by its young people.
- (A) Young people should take an interest in plans for national development.
 - (B) National development is dependent upon the youth.
 - (C) Young people ought to be aware of plans for the purpose of national development.
 - (D) The nation will advance through plans proposed by its young people.
13. The accident may have been due to the wetness of the road and not necessarily to careless driving.
- (A) The wetness of the road and the careless driving caused the accident.
 - (B) The accident was caused more by the wet road than by the driver's unnecessary carelessness.
 - (C) Careless driving had nothing to do with the accident which occurred on the wet road.
 - (D) The driver was involved in the accident not necessarily because he was careless but probably because the road was wet.
14. At one time or another every one of us succumbs to the common cold.
- (A) Some of us are sure to catch the cold.
 - (B) Very few of us will ever catch the cold.
 - (C) All of us eventually will contract the cold.
 - (D) All of us will be able to resist the cold eventually.

15. You have become tardy in your preparations for your examination during the last two months, so you must burn the candle at both ends during this week if you want to succeed.

- (A) If the candles are not burnt at both ends, as you prepare for your examinations this week, you will fail because you have been tardy during the last two months.
- (B) During this week if you want to succeed you must burn two candles in preparing for your examination, since you were tardy during the last two months.
- (C) If you want to pass your examination during this week, you must work doubly hard, since you were tardy during the last two months.
- (D) Since you have not done much preparation for your examinations during the last two months, this week you must work doubly hard if you want to succeed.

Items 16-20

Instructions: In the following sentences one of the underlined words may be misspelt. Choose from the three options A, B, C, the word that is misspelt. If no word is misspelt, choose option D.

16. The secretary had made up a calender of events but there was not enough stationery to give each member a copy. No error
- A B C D
17. After embarrassing his colleague his concience bothered him and he eventually apologised. No error
- A B C D
18. After the incident the boys travelled a diffrent route back to school. No error
- A B C D
19. His intelligence rather than his hieght was the deciding factor when considering him for the job. No error
- A B C D
20. The receipt of his letter assured me that such an occurence would not be experienced. No error
- A B C D

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer items 21–28 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

The Oceans

To the prejudiced eyes of land-bound humans the oceans seem like one continuous mass as homogeneous as outer space. To some extent they are, and some marine creatures treat the whole maritime world as their oyster. Some of the great whales, for instance, lunge from the surface to the depths as a matter of course, and divide their feeding and breeding between the poles and the tropics.

Equally striking to the marine scientist, however, is the variousness of the oceans. Each sea embraces several or indeed many distinct environments, each of which occupies a discrete zone. Some of these zones also vary markedly with time – through the day; with the tides, and therefore with the phases of the moon; by season; and sometimes in cycles of several years. And superimposed on all these variations in space and time are the more erratic influences of currents and of the influx of rivers.

In short, patchiness, in space and time, is as much a feature of the oceans as it is of land; indeed, ‘patchiness’ is a great principle in ecology – though it is rarely singled out as such. Each oceanic zone has its characteristic creatures – sometimes a huge variety of different types, and sometimes only a few; but many creatures, of all kinds, spend part of their lives in one kind of environment, and part in another. And because there are so many different ways of making a living in the oceans – so many permutations of habitats – there is a correspondingly huge variety of creatures; and many creatures take quite different forms, and live in quite different ways, at different stages of their lives. There are far fewer species in the oceans than on land, however, because there are no marine equivalents of the forest trees; and it is the trees that provide such a myriad of habitats for land-based creatures.

Colin Tudge, “The Oceans”, The Museum of Natural History, 1991.

21. The writer’s MAIN purpose in this passage is to

- (A) show that the ocean is very diverse
- (B) convince the reader to visit the ocean
- (C) describe the beauty of the ocean to humans
- (D) discuss the different creatures that live in the ocean

22. The word “prejudiced” (line 1) is NEAREST in meaning to

- (A) racial
- (B) biased
- (C) negative
- (D) unpleasant

23. The writer says that prejudiced eyes see the oceans as being "as homogeneous as outer space" (lines 1-2). This description suggests that the oceans seem to be
- (A) very far away
 - (B) full of shiny objects
 - (C) full of different zones
 - (D) the same continuous stretch of water
24. The statement "some marine creatures treat the whole maritime world as their oyster" (lines 2-3) suggests that they
- (A) live in oysters
 - (B) feed on oysters
 - (C) stay in one part of the ocean
 - (D) move freely throughout the oceans
25. According to the passage, 'patchiness' (line 13) refers to
- (A) variation
 - (B) confusion
 - (C) movement
 - (D) piecing together
26. Which of the following BEST describes the type of writing in this passage?
- (A) Critical
 - (B) Narrative
 - (C) Informative
 - (D) Argumentative
27. According to the passage, which of the following statements is FALSE?
- (A) There are more species in the ocean than on land.
 - (B) There are more species on land than in the ocean.
 - (C) Many ocean creatures divide their time in different parts of the ocean.
 - (D) Many sea creatures take different forms at different stages of their lives.
28. The clause "there are so many different ways of making a living in the oceans" (lines 16-17) refers to
- (A) tourists
 - (B) fishermen
 - (C) scientists
 - (D) marine creatures

Instructions: Read the following passage carefully and then answer the items on the basis of what is stated or implied.

There were three chimpanzees; I came to know them well. They were young and nimble, yet with that over-anxious, ancient of days expression of their kind; they would play for hours around a sapling outside my door, climbing and falling and wrestling with the exaggerated and over-emphatic tumbling of professional acrobats; it was impossible to believe in their naiveté, so obviously did they show off to any passerby.

They developed for myself first a powerful curiosity, which caused them to peer forever through a window, wrapped around each other in intricate patterns, and then, I rather believe, a certain affection, or at least tolerance, at which stage they would knock on the door to be admitted.

I came to feel very warmly about the apes; they would sit for hours on the floor beside my doorway, embracing each other, with their six dark sorrowful eyes fixed intently upon me. If I turned a page or crossed my legs they would stir quietly, nudging each other. To change my trousers in these circumstances became also an embarrassment, so intensely was the process observed.

There was one genuinely startling moment; I was working beside the window, grinding out from the typewriter whatever contemporary nonsense was required (in fact a fragment of this book) when I glanced round and there were the monkeys in a row, by the doorway, beating out a ragged tattoo with their fingers on the floor; a very reasonable imitation.

The chimpanzees showed interest in the mechanics of writing; more so in the process of drawing. One evening when I was sketching in the plantation, I felt those questing reflective eyes on me again, and a group of leathery fingers reached out gently for the crayon. It occurred to me that whatever the chimpanzee did with it would scarcely be more futile than what I was doing myself, and I surrendered it. The effect was gripping. To begin with, the chimpanzee darted and slashed at the paper in an uncontrolled way, tearing the sheet, sometimes missing it altogether; surprisingly soon a kind of intention came over him, and on the third or fourth fresh lead he began to draw. There is no other word to describe what in fact the ape was doing.

(Source unknown).

29. Which of the following phrases is used in (lines 1–15) to compare the chimpanzees with professional acrobats?

- (A) Young and nimble (lines 2–3)
- (B) Over-anxious ... expression (lines 3–4)
- (C) Exaggerated and over-emphatic tumbling (line 7)
- (D) Wrapped... in intricate patterns (lines 13–14)

30. When the author says that he "came to feel very warmly about the apes" (lines 18–19) he means that he
- (A) developed a genuine liking for the chimpanzees
 - (B) became enthusiastic about the chimpanzees' interest in writing
 - (C) grew embarrassed by the chimpanzees' close observation of him
 - (D) became unhappy because the chimpanzees constantly watched him with sorrowful eyes
31. The "genuinely startling moment" referred to in (lines 27–28) was caused by the
- (A) monkeys' tuneful drumming on the floor
 - (B) imitation of the writer's typing by the monkeys
 - (C) interruption of the writer's typing by the monkeys
 - (D) writer's discovery of the monkeys sitting in a row in the doorway
32. "A ragged tattoo" (line 33) means the same as
- (A) a tuneful rhythm
 - (B) an irritating noise
 - (C) a rhythmical tapping
 - (D) an irregular drumming
33. When the author says that the monkeys showed interest in the "mechanics of writing" (line 36) he means that they
- (A) looked at the way the typewriter worked
 - (B) were curious about how things are put on paper
 - (C) took away his pens, pencils and crayons
 - (D) examined the various parts of the typewriter
34. As used in line 39, "questing" means the same as
- (A) clever
 - (B) trustful
 - (C) inquisitive
 - (D) mischievous
35. The writer surrendered the crayons to the chimpanzee because he
- (A) had completed his own drawing
 - (B) felt that the chimpanzee could do no worse than himself
 - (C) knew that the effect would be exciting
 - (D) sensed that the chimpanzee might be able to draw quite well
36. We can infer from, "The effect was gripping" (line 44) that the author was
- (A) amazed at the drawings created by the chimpanzee
 - (B) interested in finding out what the chimpanzee would do next
 - (C) afraid that the chimpanzee might become engaged in a futile exercise
 - (D) impressed by the chimpanzee's uncontrollable darting and slashing at the paper
37. The passage can best be described as
- (A) narrative
 - (B) scientific
 - (C) explanatory
 - (D) imaginative

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer the items on the basis of what is stated or implied.

Accounting

- Nights too warm for TV
we're flung outdoors to the porch,
citronella candles scenting the space
between us, our faces aglow
5 in gold light. She crowds the card table
with coin banks, an *abacus,
five and ten dollar rolling paper,
our tidy ledger.
- 10 I count, line the coins in neat rows,
the abacus clicking out our worth,
how much can we save, stack up
against the seasons – winter coming,
her tightly braided hair turning white;
her hands quick, filling the paper casings
15 like homemade sausage.
- There's money in the bank downtown,
but this we'll keep at home
buried in jars beneath the house,
the crawlspace filling up, packed solid
20 as any foundation.

* a device for making calculations

*N.D. Trethewey, "Accounting", Callaloo, Vol. 19, No.12
Spring 1996, p.349*

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38. The activity described in the poem is
- (A) playing cards
 - (B) counting money
 - (C) making sausages
 - (D) viewing television
39. 'She' in the poem is MOST likely
- (A) thrifty
 - (B) miserly
 - (C) mercenary
 - (D) extravagant
40. Line 3 of the poem is an example of
- (A) repetition
 - (B) assonance
 - (C) alliteration
 - (D) euphemism
41. "She crowds the card table ..." (line 5) suggests that
- (A) the card table is packed
 - (B) there are many card tables
 - (C) she sits close to the card table
 - (D) many people sit around the card table

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42. The comparison between the paper casings and homemade sausages (lines 14–15) is a reference to

- (A) weight
- (B) colour
- (C) shape
- (D) quantity

43. The “crawlspac” (line 19) MOST likely refers to

- (A) a large container
- (B) a low, cramped area
- (C) very slow movement
- (D) the foundation of the house

44. The money is being saved to

- (A) keep it safe
- (B) package in paper casing
- (C) place in the bank downtown
- (D) safeguard against need in winter

45. The phrase “solid as any foundation” (lines 19–20) suggests

- (A) how fragile the jars were
- (B) what a huge fortune was buried
- (C) how secure it made the owners feel
- (D) that the foundations needed reinforcement

Instructions: Read the following passage carefully and then answer items 46–54 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

MUSIC TOO LOUD, I CAN'T STUDY

THE EDITOR: I just can't take it anymore. I just can't take the noise forced on me by a restaurant and bar located across the street. The noise is unbearable and I cannot concentrate on my studies. I am writing the CXC exams in May/June this year and I must pass all my subjects. I am attending a reputable girls' school and I want to achieve good grades to get into the CAPE class. I work hard and every report so far indicates that I am an above-average student.

I want to make my mother proud. She is a hard-working woman, especially since my father passed away two years ago. We have been struggling to make ends meet without complaint. But I must complain now because the restaurant and bar is intent on frustrating my ambitions and the sacrifices my mother is making. I appreciate the help of the Government in providing opportunities for education but this is going to be futile unless it is possible to take full advantage of them. Can you imagine having to struggle with a Math problem with thunderous noise bombarding your eardrums and everything in the house jumping up and down as if the place is haunted? Can you imagine speaking to a classmate about homework and you can't hear each other? Can you imagine stuffing cotton in your ears in order to get some sleep? Can you imagine trying to explain to your teacher that you didn't do your homework or that you sleep in class because of the noise coming from the restaurant and bar?

The noise coming from this place is a serious obstacle that I am unable to overcome and I am seeking help in dealing with it.

Can you imagine my mother and her 16-year-old daughter going to this place in the midst of riotous drinking to ask them to turn down the music because I want to study or just to get some sleep? I understand that residents have been calling the police but the response has been ineffective. At the moment of writing this letter (Sunday 19, at 9:30 am) they are blasting away after going late into last night.

Under the guise of Carnival they will continue their merciless onslaught. From Carnival Friday night right up until Ash Wednesday morning they will continue non-stop. There will be total madness.

M. Sutton, "Music too loud, I can't study", Newsday February 23, 2006.

46. The words, "I just can't take it anymore" (line 1), imply that the writer is

- (A) crying
- (B) arguing
- (C) hurting
- (D) shouting

47. The repetition of "I" in the first paragraph can be BEST interpreted as highlighting the writer's

- (A) protest
- (B) frustration
- (C) disapproval
- (D) point of view

48. Which of the following devices does the writer use in paragraph 2 to explain her plight?
- (A) Pun
 - (B) Litotes
 - (C) Contrast
 - (D) The rhetorical question
49. Which of the following words BEST conveys the emotion that the writer is seeking to arouse in the reader?
- (A) Pity
 - (B) Love
 - (C) Horror
 - (D) Empathy
50. The following sentence "I work hard and every report so far indicates that I am an above-average student" (line 5) suggests that the writer
- (A) is boastful
 - (B) is pleading
 - (C) wants to sustain this
 - (D) is about to fail her exams
51. "...jumping up and down as if the place is haunted"(line 12) is an example of which of the following devices?
- (A) Simile
 - (B) Paradox
 - (C) Irony
 - (D) Personification
52. What effect does the writer achieve when she says "Can you imagine my mother and her 16-year-old daughter going to this place in the midst of riotous drinking..." (lines 19-20)?
- (A) Admiration from the reader for the women's courage
 - (B) Shock from the reader that the women should consider going there
 - (C) Criticism for their actions in going to a bar
 - (D) Scorn for the women's behaviour in going into a bar
53. The last line of the passage expresses the view that
- (A) Carnival will be more festive
 - (B) the writer's mother will quarrel with the restaurant owner
 - (C) the writer will become hysterical
 - (D) the noisy atmosphere will become worse
54. This kind of writing is BEST classified as
- (A) narrative
 - (B) descriptive
 - (C) informative
 - (D) persuasive

Instructions: Read the following information carefully and then answer items 55–60 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

A Jamaica Kincaid Chronology

“I became a writer out of desperation . . . I started to write about my own life and I came to see that this act saved my life” (*My Brother*)

- 1949 Born in Antigua, May 25, as Elaine Potter Richardson
- 1965 Sent to US as a domestic helper
- 1969 Studies photography at New School of Social Research, NYC, and Franconia College, New Hampshire, then takes various short-term jobs and freelance writing assignments (*Ingenue*, *Ms.*, *Village Voice*)
- 1973 Changes name to Jamaica Kincaid
- 1974 First piece published in *The New Yorker*
- 1976 Staff writer at *The New Yorker*
- 1979 Marries composer Allen Shawn
- 1983 At the Bottom of the River, Morton Dauwen Zabel Award
- 1985 Writes *Annie John*; moves to Bennington, Vermont; daughter Annie born
- 1986 Annie, Gwen, Lilly, Pam, and Tulip; revisits Antigua
- 1988 *A Small Place* (book)
- 1989 Guggenheim Fellowship; son Harold born
- 1990 *Lucy*; Annie Drew visits Vermont
- 1994 Joins African American Studies Department at Harvard
- 1995 Leaves *The New Yorker*
- 1996 *The Autobiography of My Mother* (book)
- 1997 *My Brother* (book)
- 1998 *My Favourite Plant* (editor)
- 1999 *My Garden* (book)
- 2001 *Talk Stories* (book)
- 2002 *Mr Potter* (book)

55. What is the birth name of the author?

- (A) Annie John
- (B) Allen Shawn
- (C) Elaine Richardson
- (D) Jamaica Kincaid

56. According to the chronology, when did the author's publishing career start?

- (A) 1973
- (B) 1974
- (C) 1976
- (D) 1988

57. What was the author's first job in the United States?

- (A) A writer
- (B) A journalist
- (C) A researcher
- (D) A domestic helper

58. In what year did the author return to Antigua?

- (A) 1965
- (B) 1974
- (C) 1985
- (D) 1986

59. According to the chronology, how many years separated the author's two children?

- (A) 3 years
- (B) 4 years
- (C) 5 years
- (D) 10 years

60. Under which name did the author publish the book *The Autobiography of My Mother*?

- (A) Annie Drew
- (B) Elaine Shawn
- (C) Elaine Richardson
- (D) Jamaica Kincaid

END OF TEST

IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS TEST.